

ADVANCING EQUITY, DIVERSITY

EDICT

AND INCLUSION IN CLINICAL TRIALS

PROGRAMME

EDICT Kick-Off & First Training Event

23rd to 25th September 2026 | Galway, Ireland



**Funded by
the European Union**

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Programme

Training Event 1: Research excellence in equity, diversity, and inclusion (EDI) in trials | 2 ECTS

Earning your 2 ECTS

To be awarded the 2 ECTS credits for EDICT training events, doctoral candidates must:

- Complete any assigned pre-reading (we'll be in touch beforehand if this applies)
- Attend all sessions across the three days
- Complete the post-event assessment

Welcome & Foundations

Morning: joint session for all supervisors and DCs.

Afternoon: supervisors attend consortium kick-off meeting, DCs have a parallel session.

VENUE The View, Áras na Mac Léinn, University of Galway

TIME	SESSION	PRESENTER
09:15 – 09:30	Registration	
09:30 – 10:20	Formal welcome & overview of EDICT	Prof Declan Devane & Dr Emma Kirwan
10:20 – 10:50	Supervisors and Doctoral Candidate introductions	Doctoral Candidates & Supervisors
10:50 – 11:10	MORNING COFFEE BREAK	
11:10 – 11:40	The importance of this work: contextual opening on EDI in clinical trials	Prof Shaun Treweek
11:40 – 12:00	Introduction to what DCs should expect: programme structure, milestones, secondments, supports etc.	Dr Emma Kirwan
12:00 – 13:00	LUNCH 📍 Moffetts Restaurant	

Afternoon Sessions

SUPERVISOR TRACK The View, Áras na Mac Léinn, University of Galway

DOCTORAL CANDIDATE TRACK Meeting Room 1/2, Áras na Mac Léinn, University of Galway

TIME	SUPERVISOR TRACK	DOCTORAL CANDIDATE TRACK
13:00 – 15:00	EDICT Consortium Kick-Off Meeting Governance, financial management, & reporting Supervision, secondments & development Prof Declan Devane & Dr Emma Kirwan	Patient and Public Involvement and Engagement (PPIE) in clinical trials Charlene Young
15:00 – 15:20	AFTERNOON COFFEE BREAK	
15:20 – 17:00	REA Coordinators' Information Day video Pre-recorded (EU/REA) Mid-term meeting planning Training event planning Consortium Wrap-up & close of Day 1 Prof Declan Devane	15:20 - 16:00 PPIE in doctoral research: what I learned from doing my PhD with 669 members of the public Éile Quinn 16:00 - 16:45 Navigating a doctoral network: insights from a Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions Doctoral Network (MSCA-DN) graduate Dr Melissa Sharp 16:45 - 17:00 Wrap-up

Network Dinner

TIME	SESSION
19:00	EDICT Network Dinner  Galway Bay Hotel Salthill Rd Lower, Upper Salthill, Galway, H91 W295

Core Training Day

VENUE The View, Áras na Mac Léinn, University of Galway

Attendance is mandatory for doctoral candidates. Supervisors are welcome to join but attendance is not necessary. Meeting Room 1/2 is available to supervisors as a workspace throughout the event.

TIME	SESSION	PRESENTER
09:00 – 09:10	Day 2 welcome & overview of the day	Dr Emma Kirwan
09:10 – 10:10	Sense about Science “Standing Up for Science” workshop (Group Discussion)	Clare Baker
10:10 – 11:25	Sense about Science “Standing Up for Science” workshop (Panel 1: Researchers and engagement) Panellists: Dr Barbara Whelan, Dr Nikita Burke, Dr Paula Byrne	Clare Baker
11:25 – 11:40	MORNING COFFEE BREAK	
11:40 – 13:15	Sense about Science “Standing Up for Science” workshop (Panel 2: What journalists and policymakers are looking for) Panellists: Dr Teresa Maguire, Denis Naughten, Niamh Connolly	Clare Baker
13:15 – 14:15	LUNCH 📍 Moffetts Restaurant	
14:15 – 15:15	Existing frameworks to help make trials inclusive and informative	Prof Shaun Treweek
15:15 – 15:30	AFTERNOON COFFEE BREAK	
15:30 – 16:00	Building equity, diversity, and inclusion into a clinical trial	Dr Sinéad Hynes & Eva O’Byrne
16:00 – 16:45	Evidence gaps from current trial approaches and how trial innovation could address some of the barriers towards EDI	Dr Mira Zuidgeest & Dr Sanne Peters
16:45 – 17:00	Day 2 wrap-up	Dr Emma Kirwan

Training, Doctoral Forum & Close

VENUE The View, Áras na Mac Léinn, University of Galway

Attendance is mandatory for doctoral candidates. Supervisors are welcome to join but attendance is not necessary. Meeting Room 1/2 is available to supervisors as a workspace throughout the event.

TIME	SESSION	PRESENTER
09:20 – 09:30	Day 3 welcome & overview of the day	Dr Emma Kirwan
09:30 – 10:45	How to make trials more inclusive (Part 1)	Prof Shaun Treweek
10:45 – 11:00	MORNING COFFEE BREAK	
11:00 – 11:45	How to make trials more inclusive (Part 2)	Prof Shaun Treweek
11:45 – 12:30	Understanding and addressing inequitable participation in clinical research: an interactive, theory-informed case study	Dr Magdalena Rzewuska Diaz
12:30 – 13:30	LUNCH 📍 Moffetts Restaurant	
13:30 – 14:15	AI-assisted coding in clinical research: practical uses, safeguards, and reproducibility	Dr Conor Judge
14:15 – 14:55	EDICT Doctoral Forum: structure, schedule & expectations. DCs select representatives and agree roles within the Forum, along with the journal club format and dates.	Dr Emma Kirwan
14:55 – 15:15	Round-up Q&A	Dr Emma Kirwan
15:15 – 15:30	Closing remarks & next steps	Prof Declan Devane & Dr Emma Kirwan

15:30 END OF EVENT

Session details

Learning outcomes and descriptions for training event sessions.

— WEDNESDAY 23RD SEPTEMBER

WED 23 SEP • 13:00 – 15:00 • DOCTORAL CANDIDATE TRACK

Patient and Public Involvement and Engagement (PPIE) in clinical trials workshop

Charlene Young

LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, participants will be able to:

- Understand the value and purpose of PPIE in clinical trials.
- Understand what meaningful PPIE looks like in practice and explore approaches to involving diverse and underserved populations.

WHAT'S COVERED

- What meaningful (rather than tokenistic) involvement looks like.
- Working with diverse and underserved communities, and sustaining involvement without over-burdening or under-recognising contributors.

WED 23 SEP • 15:20 – 16:00 • DOCTORAL CANDIDATE TRACK

PPIE in doctoral research: what I learned from doing my PhD with 669 members of the public

Éile Quinn

LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, participants will be able to:

- Understand how PPIE can be embedded in doctoral research from a PhD candidate's perspective.
- Take away practical lessons and reflections from a large-scale public involvement experience.

WHAT'S COVERED

Reflections on doing a PhD with meaningful public involvement, including what worked and what was learned along the way.

WED 23 SEP • 16:00 – 16:45 • DOCTORAL CANDIDATE TRACK

Navigating a doctoral network: insights from a Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions Doctoral Network (MSCA-DN) graduate

Dr Melissa Sharp

LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, participants will be able to:

- Recognise what to expect as a doctoral candidate within an MSCA Doctoral Network, drawing on lived experience.
- Identify practical strategies for making the most of the network.

WHAT'S COVERED

An informal, first-hand look at the journey through an MSCA Doctoral Network, from the perspective of a MIROR MSCA-DN graduate.

Thursday 24th September

THU 24 SEP · 09:10 – 13:15 · HALF-DAY WORKSHOP

Standing Up for Science

Clare Baker, Sense about Science

LEARNING OUTCOMES

- Understand the importance of engaging in public discussions around science and evidence.
- Understand how the media and policy worlds work and to learn how researchers can engage with these stakeholders to improve understanding of both their own research, and research more generally.

WHAT'S COVERED

- Group session on your worries and concerns talking about research: participants discuss their individual and shared concerns, that can then be picked up in the panel discussions.
- A panel of 3 researchers further along in their careers will share their experiences – both good and bad – of engaging with the media and policy worlds.
- A panel of journalists and policy professionals will explain how they approach reporting science, how evidence is used in policy and what both worlds need from scientists to work effectively.

Panel 1 — Researchers and engagement

Three researchers further along in their careers

1. Dr Barbara Whelan, Evidence-to-Policy Lead, Evidence Synthesis Ireland
2. Dr Nikita Burke, Programme Manager, Evidence Synthesis Ireland
3. Dr Paula Byrne, Senior Research Fellow (Evidence Synthesis Methodologist), Evidence Synthesis Hub for Health Security Ireland

Panel 2 — Journalists and policymakers

Three communications and policy professionals

1. Dr Teresa Maguire, Director of Research Strategy and Funding, Health Research Board
2. Denis Naughten, Public policy knowledge broker, InnoSphere Consulting
3. Niamh Connolly, Head of Engagement and Communications, BioInnovate Ireland

Thursday 24th September • continued

THU 24 SEP • 14:15 – 15:15

Existing frameworks to help make trials inclusive and informative

Prof Shaun Treweek

LEARNING OUTCOMES

- Understand the landscape of existing frameworks that can help to make trials more inclusive and informative.
- Understand that paying greater attention to who is in a trial is above all about applicability and informativeness.

WHAT'S COVERED

- Basic principles around what inclusive trials are.
- Presentation of some frameworks that can help trial teams to think about how to design, deliver and report an inclusive trial.
- An explanation of trial informativeness and why considering who is in your trial (and reporting this) are key to trials that are informative and useful.
- The session will be a lecture, with some interactive discussions with the audience throughout. Questions and discussion will be encouraged.

THU 24 SEP • 15:30 – 16:00

Building equity, diversity, and inclusion into a clinical trial

Dr Sinéad Hynes & Eva O'Byrne

LEARNING OUTCOMES

- Identify structural and design-related barriers that limit diverse participation in clinical trials. Specific examples will be provided from the Cognitive Occupation-Based programme for people with Multiple Sclerosis (COB-MS) definitive trial.
- Apply practical strategies for inclusive recruitment, retention, and data collection across the trial lifecycle.

WHAT'S COVERED

This session will examine the structural and design-related barriers that limit diverse participation in clinical trials, drawing on specific examples from the COB-MS definitive trial. Participants will explore strategies for improving recruitment, retention, and data collection across the trial lifecycle. The session will combine presentation and case-based discussion.

THU 24 SEP • 16:00 – 16:45

Evidence gaps from current trial approaches and how trial innovation could address some of the barriers towards EDI

Dr Mira Zuidgeest & Dr Sanne Peters

LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, participants will be able to better understand how current trial approaches lead to evidence gaps and how trial innovation could address some of the barriers.

WHAT'S COVERED

Topics:

- eligibility criteria
- sample size
- pragmatic & decentralised trial approaches

Friday 25th September

FRI 25 SEP • 09:30 – 11:45 • PARTS 1–2, WITH COFFEE BREAK

How to make trials more inclusive

Prof Shaun Treweek

LEARNING OUTCOMES

- Understand terminology around inclusion, diversity and equity.
- Have some case studies that highlight why poor inclusion is a problem.
- Understand the importance of thinking carefully about who should be in a trial, what to do to recruit and retain the people you need, and how to report all of this.

WHAT'S COVERED

- Terminology around equity, diversity and inclusion.
- Why thinking about inclusion is important.
- How to decide who should be in a trial, and what to do to recruit and retain the people you identify.
- How to report who is in your trial and use this information to make decisions about applicability.
- This workshop is a mix of lecture, small group work, questions and discussion.

FRI 25 SEP • 11:45 – 12:30

Understanding and addressing inequitable participation in clinical research: an interactive, theory-informed case study

Dr Magdalena Rzewuska Diaz

LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, participants will be able to:

- Identify and define an equity problem in clinical trial recruitment by comparing the characteristics of eligible and recruited populations.
- Apply the COM-B (behaviour change) model to stakeholder perspectives to develop a behavioural diagnosis of the capability, opportunity and motivation factors influencing participation.
- Use the Behaviour Change Wheel to select appropriate intervention functions and translate them into practical, equity-focused implementation actions.

SESSION DESCRIPTION

This interactive, case-based session introduces a structured, theory-informed approach to addressing inequitable participation in clinical research.

Working in small groups, participants will examine monitoring data from a fictional multicentre diabetes trial to identify which population groups are underrepresented. They will analyse stakeholder perspectives, classify the perceived reasons influencing participation using the six COM-B domains, and synthesise these into a behavioural diagnosis. Participants will select a priority COM-B domain, use the Behaviour Change Wheel to identify appropriate intervention functions, and translate these into practical implementation actions designed to improve equitable participation.

The session will demonstrate how implementation science can help teams move beyond overall recruitment targets to understand who is participating, why inequities may arise, and what could be changed in response.

Friday 25th September · continued

FRI 25 SEP · 13:30 – 14:15

AI-assisted coding in clinical research: practical uses, safeguards, and reproducibility

Dr Conor Judge

LEARNING OUTCOMES

- Identify research and software-development tasks for which Claude Code can provide practical support.
- Apply the explore, plan, code commit methodology.
- Apply appropriate oversight, testing, version control and data-governance safeguards when using AI-assisted coding in clinical research.

WHAT'S COVERED

This practical session will demonstrate the use of Claude Code across clinical research, data analysis and software-development projects, including the development of AI-BP, a clinician-facing decision-support system for hypertension.

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SEE YOU IN GALWAY

Thank you

edictproject.eu

edict@universityofgalway.ie



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HRVATSKO
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